

Nicholas Getka

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 8+ years of experience across frontend, backend, and infrastructure-focused delivery. I started with JavaScript and Vue, then expanded into full-stack development with PHP and Laravel, API design using the JSON:API specification, and MySQL performance optimization. I have led architecture decisions, mentored developers, and delivered high-quality software with strong testing, observability, and production reliability practices.

Work Experience

Home Depot

JUNIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Austin, TX

Jan. 2017 - Aug. 2017

- Implemented a React-based Checkout UI for Home Depot's e-commerce website.
- Worked on the User Account pages, built with Angular.

ReviewPush

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Austin, TX

Sept. 2017 - Present

- **Frontend Development** - Advanced to Senior Frontend Developer and technical leader, spearheading architectural decisions and delivering scalable, high-performance frontend solutions.
 - **Design System & Component Libraries** - Architected and implemented comprehensive frontend design systems and component libraries, ensuring consistency, accessibility, and scalability across the entire codebase.
 - **Legacy Migration Initiative** - Led the strategic migration from legacy Laravel Blade templates to Vue.js, resulting in significant improvements to performance, responsiveness, and delivery speed. Orchestrated the transition from BEM CSS to Tailwind CSS, reducing styling complexity and improving maintainability.
 - **Vue.js 2.x to 3.x Upgrade** - Executed comprehensive upgrade initiative, adopting the Composition API and modern reactive patterns to improve code organization, reusability, and developer experience.
 - **Testing Framework Implementation** - Established a robust testing framework using Jest and Vue Test Utils with comprehensive unit and integration test coverage, driving high code quality and reliability standards.
 - **Multi-Technology Applications** - Developed and maintained multiple auxiliary applications using Alpine.js, Laravel Livewire, Statamic, and other cutting-edge web technologies, supporting diverse project requirements.
 - **Mentorship & Code Quality** - Mentored other developers on frontend best practices, code quality standards, and modern development workflows.
- **Backend Development** - Expanded technical scope into full-stack development, taking ownership of critical backend systems and infrastructure initiatives.
 - **Laravel API & Infrastructure** - Designed and implemented new backend features and architected standardized backend patterns including service layers, repository patterns, and query optimization strategies. I have experience with API design, specifically using the JSON:API specification.
 - **Monolith Architecture Modernization** - Rearchitected the ReviewPush monolith from a controller-transformer pattern to a Controller-Service-Transformer model. Introduced modular, reusable service classes for business logic, leaving controllers to validate requests and transformers to produce JSON:API responses, substantially improving readability testability and code coverage.
 - **Testing Framework Overhaul** - Implemented a comprehensive testing strategy that transformed the backend from sporadic, ad-hoc tests to a robust suite of unit and integration tests, improving release confidence and software quality.
 - **Real-Time Messaging System** - Engineered a sophisticated two-way messaging system leveraging email parsers and WebSockets, enabling seamless real-time communication between users and their customers with reliable message delivery.
 - **Full-Stack Feature Implementation** - Translated business requirements into comprehensive system enhancements across the full technology stack. For example, reimplemented a competitor analysis system with new relational controls for managing competitor locations associated with company locations via pivot tables with bidirectional querying and advanced filtering. Developed Vuex modules for centralized comparison data management and implemented multiple customer-facing pages to visualize and interact with competitor data.
 - **Database Management and Query Optimization** - I have worked extensively with a MySQL database, optimizing performance through query tuning, strategic indexing, and caching strategies.
 - **FastPDF** - Architected and deployed a Fastify microservice for generating production-grade PDF reports from complex HTML, CSS, and JavaScript pages, with comprehensive logging, health monitoring, OpenTelemetry-based observability, JWT authentication, k6 load testings and test coverage. This project is visible on my personal GitHub
- **Leadership** - Owned architecture decisions, mentored engineers, and drove business-wide priorities with a focus on performance, reliability, and software quality.

Personal Projects

- I take pride in programming as a craft and continuously strive to improve my skills with personal projects. With the rapid advancements in AI, I have been particularly focused on experimenting with various AI tools.
 - **Mystic Type-Writer** - A web application built with Svelte, SvelteKit, and Tailwind CSS, deployed on GitHub Pages.
 - **Notesboard Plus Plus** - A note-keeping application built with React, NextJS, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, and MongoDB designed to keep my notes for creative writing projects. It uses the new HTML-in-Canvas api to allow for a more customizable note-taking experience allowing images, quotes, and text to be "pinned" to the canvas.
 - **Getkan-CV** - An intelligent résumé builder that leverages content files and a custom agent to generate tailored CVs aligned with job listing requirements. It utilizes OpenRouter for AI-driven content generation and is built with Python, LaTeX, and the OpenRouter API.
- **Miss Micro's Magick Wheel** - Built a book-club recommendation wheel in React, Next.js, Prisma, and Tailwind to randomly select the next read while weighting suggestions based on prior selections and recency.
- **Linux Enthusiast** - I have a strong passion for the Linux operating system and enjoy exploring different distributions, experimenting with window managers and tiling systems, customizing my system environment, and developing utilities for everyday tasks. Currently I am experimenting with the Hyprland window manager.

About me

Georgetown University

Washington, D.C.

Sept. 2013 - May. 2017

- Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science, Bachelor of Arts in Economics
- I have lived in San Diego, California, Washington, D.C., and Austin, Texas.
- I am a passionate fan of the Baltimore Ravens, Orioles, and Miami Heat.
- Reading and writing are two of my favorite pastimes. I am a member of several local book clubs and have written for the local zine, Nopal. My goal for this year is to have one of my short stories published in a literary magazine.
- I enjoy practicing yoga and mindfulness meditation. I would like to train to become a yoga instructor at some point.